SOFA TO SINGLETRACK · MTB EAST

# The playbook

Everything the app does, in the order a rider actually meets it — from the questions at signup to the quiet nudges that bring someone back. This is written for you: it explains how each piece works, not just what it looks like.

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## 01 Signing up

About a minute, seven short steps, no account created.

### Name and experience

Three quick questions: their name, whether they've ridden off-road before, and how many days a week they can manage. The experience question isn't just for show — anyone who's ridden regularly (but never raced) starts their first session a notch harder, +5 minutes, using the same system that adjusts sessions later based on how they feel. Everyone else starts at the standard level.

### Days, and a goal

They pick exactly which 2 or 3 days suit them, then choose between an open-ended plan to just build the habit (1–3 months) or a plan built backwards from a real MTB East race date. Either way, they're on the same 12-week programme — a shorter plan just uses the first part of it. That's on purpose: one plan to keep improving, not several versions to keep in sync.

### Before your first ride

A short bike safety-check video and a fitness self-declaration — both required before they can build their programme.

## 02 Every session

The dashboard — what a rider sees on a normal Tuesday.

### Next up

The main card, always at the top: session name, an icon for the session type (hills, intervals, race simulation, and 16 more), a date badge, and a 3-dot effort rating — easy, moderate, or hard — tagged across all 24 sessions in the plan.

### Tap-to-define jargon

Terms like **cadence**, **singletrack** or **clipping in** are underlined right inside the session text. Tap one and a plain-English definition appears underneath — no need to leave the session or go and look it up.

### "Why this session?"

Sessions with a specific coaching reason — intervals, race simulation, course recon, start practice — get a small question mark that explains why it's there, in one sentence. Easy spins don't get one; not everything needs justifying.

### Ride timer

Count up to just track how long they're out, or count down from the session's planned time. The clock sits above the button rather than replacing it, so starting a ride never feels like losing a control. When a countdown hits zero: the screen flashes red, a chime plays, and the phone vibrates — then it keeps counting as overtime instead of just freezing at zero.

### Before you head out

A six-item pre-ride checklist — helmet, water, layers, phone, tyres, tell someone where you're going — collapsed by default with a live count, so it's there without adding to the scroll.

### Video demo

Shows a "coming soon" placeholder until a real YouTube video is added for that session — then it switches automatically to a real thumbnail and link, no code changes needed.

## 03 Tracking progress

The rest of the dashboard, below the current session.

### The gauge, time, and streak

One glance at percentage of the programme complete, total minutes ridden, and the longest run of consecutive weeks with something logged. A streak survives a single skipped session — it only breaks if a whole week goes by with nothing at all.

### Trophy case

Badges for first ride, first week, first month, two months, three months, 5 hours ridden, and bouncing back after a quiet week — each one triggers confetti and a toast the second it's earned.

### Calendar

A month view with colour-coded dots for done, skipped, upcoming, and extra rides. Tap any day for a quick preview of what happened.

### Off-plan rides

"Log a ride" captures anything that wasn't on the schedule — its own date, duration, and how it felt — and it counts toward streaks and badges just like a planned session.

## 04 Staying engaged

The two nudges that happen without anyone asking.

### The comeback nudge

If 14 days pass with no real ride logged — from their last genuine ride, or from day one if they never started — the next time they open the app they see *"your bike misses you."* That's it. No follow-up, no repeats. It only ever fires once, so it can't turn into a nag.

### Race discount offer

Two weeks into the programme, a one-time banner invites them to enter the **Fun category** at a discount. It's not just "the next race" — the app works out when their programme finishes and looks for the first race after that date, so it never suggests racing mid-training. Same rule as the comeback nudge: shown once, then gone for good.

### Finish screen

Finishing every session unlocks its own screen: a shareable achievement image made on the spot, and either a nudge toward the next race or a simple "keep riding, no plan needed."

## 05 Getting help

Reference material, kept out of the way until it's wanted.

### Get in touch

Contact a coach (a short form, emailed to MTB East), the race calendar, sharing the app, and a feedback link — plus donation buttons for £5, £10, or any amount, since the app stays free.

### Tips & advice

One collapsed section for fuelling tips, bike care, trail etiquette, a step-by-step bike setup check, and an FAQ — closed by default so it doesn't clutter the dashboard, but one tap away when it's wanted.

## 06 Behind the scenes

Settings, privacy, and how the app is actually built.

### Settings

Change training days if a schedule shifts partway through — progress is tracked by week number, not date, so nothing gets lost. Also: download a full backup of a rider's progress, or restore one, for switching phones or clearing a browser.

### Privacy, by construction

There's no backend and no accounts. Everything — profile, progress, badges — stays in that one browser. MTB East can't see it, and neither can anyone else. GoatCounter logs anonymous, cookie-free visit counts and nothing more.

### Installable, and works offline

Add it to a home screen for a proper app icon, and once installed it keeps working with no signal — the whole programme is cached on the device.